Competitor watch · Q3 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison: listed companies

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**Q3 2026 trading update**	**823.3 EUR**	**+6.6%**	**+13.0%**	**13.8%**	**+130 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	Q3 2026 trading update	–	+3.0%	+2.0%	–		Adj. operating margin
Belimo	no report for this period						
Xylem	Q3 2026 results	2,201 USD	−3.0%	0.0%	23.9%	+70 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q3 2026 results	4,695 USD	+12.7%	+7.0%	19.6%	+70 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	*Q3 2026 results — due 4 Nov 2026*						
Emerson[1]	Q3 2026 results (quarter ended 30 Jun 2026)	4,873 USD	+7.0%	+6.0%	28.5%	+140 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q3 2026 results	976.0 USD	−4.5%	−5.0%	24.8%	−90 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report for this period						
Danfoss[2]	no report for this period						

Organic growth by quarter

Company	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025	FY 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026
Aalberts	**−3.3%**	**−3.2%**	**−1.9%**	**−2.5%**	**+2.8%**	**+5.0%**	**+13.0%**
IMI	−3.0%	+2.0%	+12.0%	+5.0%	+5.0%	+5.0%	+2.0%
Belimo	–	+20.6%	–	+23.3%	–	+29.6%	–
Xylem	+3.0%	+6.0%	+7.0%	+5.0%	0.0%	+1.0%	0.0%
Ecolab	+3.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+4.0%	+5.0%	+7.0%
Watts	−2.1%	+5.8%	+9.4%	+5.3%	+11.9%	+12.2%	due
Emerson[1]	+2.0%	+2.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+2.0%	+0.5%	+6.0%
Pentair	−0.8%	+1.3%	+3.3%	–	+1.1%	−17.3%	−5.0%
Georg Fischer	–	+0.1%	–	−1.7%	–	+5.7%	–
Danfoss[2]	–	−3.0%	–	+3.0%	–	+15.0%	–

Notes: organic growth as each company defines it.

Reported margin by quarter

Company	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025	FY 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Margin measure
Aalberts	**13.6%** −60 bps	**13.5%** −150 bps	**12.5%** −120 bps	**13.2%** −180 bps	**14.2%** +60 bps	**14.4%** +90 bps	**13.8%** +130 bps	**EBITA margin**
IMI	–	18.2% +30 bps	–	20.0% +30 bps	–	18.7% +50 bps	–	Adj. operating margin
Belimo	–	22.8% +320 bps	–	20.8% +159 bps	–	22.5% −30 bps	–	EBIT margin
Xylem	20.4% +120 bps	21.8% +100 bps	23.2% +200 bps	22.2% +160 bps	20.6% +20 bps	23.3% +150 bps	23.9% +70 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	16.0% +190 bps	18.3% +170 bps	18.7% +110 bps	17.9% +150 bps	16.7% +70 bps	18.8% +40 bps	19.6% +70 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	19.0%	21.6%	18.5% +140 bps	19.6% +190 bps	20.1% +110 bps	21.0% −60 bps	due	Adj. operating margin
Emerson[1]	28.0% +340 bps	28.0% +200 bps	27.1% 0 bps	27.6% +160 bps	27.7% −30 bps	27.6% −40 bps	28.5% +140 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	24.0%	26.4%	25.7%	–	25.0% +100 bps	25.4% −100 bps	24.8% −90 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	–	10.4% −130 bps	–	11.4% −150 bps	–	13.4%	–	Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions
Danfoss[2]	–	10.6% −90 bps	–	12.9% +40 bps	–	15.3% +350 bps	–	Operational EBITA margin

Notes: [1] Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them. [2] Danfoss is not listed on a stock exchange (owned by the Danfoss family and the Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation), so it has no share price; it is included because it publishes audited financial results, half-year and full-year only.

Key messages: listed companies · Q3 2026

1. Overall performance

- **Aalberts**: revenue **823.3** EUR m (+6.6%), organic **+13.0%**, EBITA margin **13.8%** +130 bps. All three segments improved organic growth and EBITA margin; added value margin remained at a good level.
- **IMI**: organic **+2.0%**. Process Automation orders +19% organic in Q3 (+14% YTD; new construction +27%, aftermarket +7%); revenue −6% on shipment timing.
- **Belimo** (Q2 2026 report): Sales CHF 676.4m, +20.5% in CHF and +29.6% in local currencies; data centres delivered a bit more than half of the absolute growth.
- **Xylem**: revenue **2,201** USD m (−3.0%), organic **0.0%**, Adj. EBITDA margin **23.9%** +70 bps. Orders USD 2,331m, +10% organic, book-to-bill >1; backlog USD 5.5bn (+16% organic).
- **Ecolab**: revenue **4,695** USD m (+12.7%), organic **+7.0%**, Organic operating margin **19.6%** +70 bps. Organic operating margin 19.6% (+70 bps); adjusted operating income +14%.
- **Watts** (Q2 2026 report): Record sales USD 763m, +19% reported and +12% organic; adj. EPS $3.66 (+18%), above consensus (~$3.33).
- **Emerson**[1]: revenue **4,873** USD m (+7.0%), organic **+6.0%**, Adj. segment EBITA margin **28.5%** +140 bps. Adj. segment EBITA margin 28.5% (+140 bps); adj. EPS $1.71 (+13%), above guidance.
- **Pentair**: revenue **976.0** USD m (−4.5%), organic **−5.0%**, Adj. return on sales **24.8%** −90 bps. Adj. operating income USD 242m (−8%), adj. return on sales 24.8%.
- **Georg Fischer** (Q2 2026 report): Now a pure-play Flow Solutions group: Flow Solutions sales CHF 1,584m, +5.1% (+5.7% organic).
- **Danfoss**[2] (Q2 2026 report): Sales EUR 5,254m (4,703m), organic +15% led by North America and Asia (China, India); all three segments grew with strong order intake.

2. M&A moves

- **Aalberts**: GVT post-merger integration (semicon) completed.
- **IMI**: Agreed acquisition of iSMA CONTROLLI (Oct 2026): a bolt-on in smart-connected building controls for small and medium-sized commercial buildings.
- **Belimo** (Q2 2026 report): No acquisitions or disposals found for 2026; growth is organic, backed by capacity investment.
- **Xylem**: Acquisitions of Cornell & Roper (expected Q4 2026) and WaterFleet (~USD 200m, signed in Q2) to rotate toward higher-growth markets.
- **Ecolab**: CoolIT Systems (data-centre liquid cooling) closed 2 Jul 2026 for ~USD 4.75bn cash (USD 4.63bn net of cash); ~USD 550m sales expected in the first 12 months.
- **Watts** (Q2 2026 report): Acquisitions added USD 34m of revenue in Q2 (5 pts of growth)
- **Emerson**[1]: No new acquisitions or disposals announced in the quarter; portfolio focus remains on automation after the 2025 buy-out of AspenTech minorities.
- **Pentair**: Acquisition of Taco (Taco Group Holdings, HVAC hydronics) completed 1 Oct 2026: ~USD 560m sales in 2026 (+~23%), >USD 620m expected in 2027.
- **Georg Fischer** (Q2 2026 report): Majority of GF Casting Solutions sold in February 2026
- **Danfoss**[2] (Q2 2026 report): Bought the remaining 38% of Semikron Danfoss (power semiconductors) in Q1 2026, now 100% owned.

3. Operations, innovation and production

- **Aalberts**: Operational excellence programmes and footprint optimisation in building and industry.
- **IMI**: £500m share buyback (£250m done by June); interim dividend +10% to 12.1p.
- **Belimo** (Q2 2026 report): Capacity: new production and logistics building in Hinwil (CH) opened Aug 2026; 170,000 sq ft warehouse in Stratford, CT
- **Xylem**: From 1 Jan 2027, four segments become three: Treatment & Services (~USD 3.5bn), Flow Solutions (~2.6bn), Measurement & Analytics (~2.1bn)
- **Ecolab**: Ecolab Digital sales +34% to USD 129m.
- **Watts** (Q2 2026 report): Data centre sales more than tripled to ~8% of H1 sales, driven by the newly launched CoolVault thermal storage tanks.
- **Emerson**[1]: ~USD 2.2bn shareholder returns planned for FY 2026, including USD 1bn of buybacks (USD 898m done by fiscal Q3).
- **Pentair**: Pool channel inventory realignment with major partners completed
- **Georg Fischer** (Q2 2026 report): Net debt CHF 1,684m at end-2025 after the transformation
- **Danfoss**[2] (Q2 2026 report): Data centres drive growth in all three segments: air- and liquid-cooling, power conversion, energy storage and heat recovery for hyperscalers and chip makers.

Sources: each company's report for the period.

Other key competitors · Q3 2026

Private companies and divisions, by relevance to HFC.

Company (relevance)	Performance	M&A	Operations
Caleffi very high (5/5)			INTERCLIMA 2026 (Paris, 28 Sep – 1 Oct): exhibited co-branded with its long-standing French distribution partner Thermador.
Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) very high (5/5)			Reported 15 Jul 2026: Rimavská Sobota is reflexGroup's eighth production site, adding capacity for domestic hot water and buffer tanks; designed for ~450 employees.
Grundfos high (4/5)		Completed the acquisition of EUWA (Gärtringen, Germany; water treatment for breweries and soft drinks, installations in >110 countries), announced mid-July 2026; extends its water-treatment platform after Newterra.	WEFTEC 2026 (New Orleans, 26–30 Sep): unveiled a combined water-treatment offer bringing Newterra, MECO and Water Works under the Grundfos brand together with its own pumps.
Armstrong Fluid Technology moderate (3/5)			Showcased HVAC and intelligent fluid-flow solutions at BEX Asia, Singapore (Sep 2026).
Fernox moderate (3/5)	Element Solutions Q3 2026: Specialties segment (incl.		
Siemens Smart Infrastructure[1] moderate (3/5)	Fiscal Q3 2026: orders EUR 8.0bn (+42%, record), revenue EUR 6.4bn (+13% comparable), profit EUR 1.3bn (20.0%); backlog EUR 23.7bn		
Wilo moderate (3/5)			Established Wilo Japan (Aug 2026), targeting data centres.
Alfa Laval low (2/5)	Q3 2026: record order intake SEK 23.2bn (+33% organic), net sales SEK 18.6bn (~+6% organic), adj. EBITA margin 18.1% (18.4%); data-centre orders ~SEK 2bn in the quarter.		
Resideo (Honeywell Home) low (2/5)		Completed the separation of ADI (distribution) on 3 Aug 2026; standalone Q3 guide USD 705–730m revenue	
Victaulic low (2/5)		Acquired Arumani to expand European modular construction and mechanical assemblies (Aug 2026)	

Notes: [1] Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them.